

P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Section: 29069

Semester: Spring 2025

Class Time: MWF, 10:25 – 11:15AM

Location: Woodburn Hall, room 111

Instructor: Hannah Ridner

Contact: hrridner@iu.edu

Office Hours: Mondays, 11:30 AM – 1:30PM, Morrison Hall, room 420

Note: This is a *shared space* so any private discussions (i.e., grades) will need to be scheduled separately with me

Course Description and Outcomes

This is an introductory course covering topics in the study of criminology and the criminal justice system. This course will be broken down into four main sections: 1) General crime and criminal justice, 2) policing, 3) courts, and 4) corrections. Major topics such as the historical background, structure, functions, and operations of the criminal justice system in the United States will be covered.

Outcomes of Course:

1. Introduce foundational concepts of criminal justice in America (i.e., major components/terms)
2. Examine how these concepts apply within the American criminal justice institutions (i.e., police, courts, corrections, and law)
3. Develop critical thinking related to issues within the American criminal justice system

Additionally, this course prepares students for more generalized skills in critical thinking, practical applications of outside resources to the criminal justice system, and scientific inquiry and analysis. The course assessments encourage critical thinking by requiring students to apply and interpret key terms, consider differing perspectives on justice equality and issues, evaluate strengths and weaknesses in current justice research, and to assess how research has informed social programs as well as consider future directions of inquiry and reform.

Course Materials

Textbook:

MindTap Introduction to Criminal Justice, 17th Edition
Larry J. Siegel; John L. Worrall
ISBN: 9780357631065

Access to the text and the rest of the Digital Learning Tool was covered through IU e-Texts and by the course fee you paid. You can get to the text through Canvas.

Canvas:

This course will use Canvas for assignments, exams, grades, any extra materials (i.e., articles), and other important information. Students should consistently be engaged with Canvas as any important announcements will be updated on the Canvas page.

Course Requirements & Assignment Descriptions

Students will be required to read assigned material before class, attend lectures, and engage with class discussions and activities. The grades for this course from exams, assignments, and weekly exercises.

Attendance/Participation: There are a total of 10 extra credit points that can be earned through attendance/participation in class. Students who attend 75% of classes will earn all 10 extra credit points, and a percentage of those 10 may be earned depending on how many classes are attended. Ideally, these points should help boost your grade. If you miss class ([see policy below](#)), **there are no makeup points available** (regardless of the reason) as there is an opportunity to receive all extra credit points with several absences. Although extra credit is an incentive, please not the *participation* part (i.e., participating when able in Menti, class discussion, paying attention). No extra credit is given for simply showing up and not participating and no extra credit is given if you are consistently late (i.e., more than a few minutes).

Exercises: There will be a total of 10 exercises throughout the semester. These will be different Canvas exercises designed to help you engage with the materials read each week. You can expect these to either be quizzes or an exercise where you listen/read outside information that relates to materials each week and respond (either as a discussion post, short answer, or multiple choice questions). These will be relatively short, and you will always get one week with the quiz. These exercises will open on Fridays, the week before they are due, and close the following **Friday at**

11:59 PM. You will have one attempt at these exercises and unlimited time. Late exercises are not permitted, as two will be dropped (see note below).

Note:* The lowest **two exercises will be dropped, with only 8 of the 10 counting towards your final grade

Assignments: There will be three major assignments during this semester. These assignments are broadly a blog post, watching/responding to a documentary (this will be available for free), and responding to questions/finding court cases. More information will be given on this and the requirements closer to when these assignments are due (they will always be open in advance before the due date and talked about in class). Each assignment is worth 25 points.

Exams: There will be **four** exams for this course. Exam questions will consist of the following types of questions: multiple choice, short answer, and true/false questions. Exams will be online on Canvas on Fridays of exam week, and open from **8:00 AM until 11:59 PM**. You may begin your exam any time during this time frame; however, note that once you start the exam, you will **only have 50 minutes** to finish the exam (the length of class). Each exam is worth 100 points each. No exams will be cumulative. More information (i.e., how many questions) will be given closer to exam time. There are no makeups for exams, as one exam will be dropped (see note below).

Note:* The **lowest exam grade will be dropped, with only **three** of the four exams counting towards your final grade.

Final Project: There will be a final project that includes the creation of a fact sheet on a criminal justice topic (of your choosing). There will be more instructions for this project released in class and on Canvas.

Topic Selection for Final Project: You will be asked to submit your topic for approval during the middle of the semester. This is to get you thinking about your final project and to make sure you are on the right track with your topic. Later instructions will be provided in class about the topic choices. This will be worth 10 points, and this assignment **must** be submitted to receive a final grade on the final project. Any resubmissions for this must be completed by the deadline on the course schedule (see below).

Final Project Presentation: More information will be given on this later in the semester, but these will be short, informal presentations (individual)

presented during the last week of classes. This will be included as part of the total points for the final project.

Grades will be assigned in a timely manner. If you have questions or concerns about your grade(s) and believe that I should review them, you should submit a written request over email within one week after the grade has been given.

Grading

Points Breakdown

	Points
Exams x3	150
Final Project	75
Topic Selection	10
Assignments x3	75
Exercises x8	80
Total Points	390

Extra Credit: 10 points (from attendance)

Final letter grades will be assigned according to the University's standard grading scale:

A+	97 to 100%	C+	77 to 79.9%
A	93 to 96.9%	C	73 to 76.9%
A-	90 to 92.9%	C-	70 to 72.9%
B+	87 to 89.9%	D+	67 to 69.9%
B	83 to 86.9%	D	63 to 66.9%
B-	80 to 82.9%	D-	60 to 62.9%
		F	below 60%

Policies (Course & IUB)

Attendance

Students are responsible for keeping up with the material covered in each class.

While I understand that it is not always possible to attend class, you are responsible for making arrangements to get notes from a classmate to make up for what you

have missed. I will not initiate contact with students about making up missed work. An instructional document titled, “*What should I do if I miss class?*” is available on Canvas. Students are responsible for completing the steps listed in this document before contacting me with questions regarding their absence. *Note that there are no makeups for attendance (for any reason), as attendance is extra credit/leeway is built into the extra credit availability*

Make-up Work and Late Assignments

***Note:** *No makeup work will be allowed if grades are already posted for the assignment*

Late Weekly Exercises or Missed Exams: Due to the flexibility in the course structure, make-up exercises or exams will **NOT** be offered. Please contact me as soon as possible (preferably before an exam or missed exercise) if you have any issues. The grading structure for this course allows students to miss two exercises without the missing scores having a negative impact on their course grade; only 8 of the 10 exercises count toward the final course grade. In addition, each course exam is offered on Canvas for an extended period of time (with one exam being dropped). Therefore, there is leeway built in for missing/forgetting/being sick, etc.

Advanced notice is required for the possibility of make-up work. Please email me **PRIOR** to missing something (note: I understand some extenuating circumstances could prevent notice prior [i.e., family death], let me know as soon as you can with any problems).

Late Assignments: These will be subject to a grading penalty. There will be a 10% grade deduction for each day the assignment is late, and assignments submitted *over 3 days beyond the due date* will not be eligible for credit (late Weekly Exercises will not be accepted). If you are unable to turn in an assignment on time, ***please get in touch with me as soon as possible***. For example, if you are ill, do *not* wait to contact me after you are better to let me know you missed an assignment. Let me know before a missed assignment, or extensions cannot be given. Note that assignments will be open for at least 2 weeks, meaning that last-minute issues (i.e., computer issues, sickness) do not necessarily constitute a reason for an extension.

Copyright

You should consider all materials in the course, including my lectures, power point slides, assignments, and notes as being subject to copyright protection. These are designed for your individual use during this course and should not be disseminated to others in any way without my express written permission.

Class Conduct

Students are expected to attend and be prepared for all classes, arrive on time, be actively engaged in class discussion and activities, and refrain from any disruptive behavior (which includes talking during the lecture). Participation in the course should maintain a positive work and learning environment, as outlined in the IU Student Code: [click here](#)

Academic Integrity & Misconduct

Academic dishonesty will not be tolerated and any violations will be reported to the Dean of Students. You are responsible for being attentive to and observant of University policies about academic honesty as stated in the [Code of Student Rights, Responsibilities, & Conduct](#). Sanctions for academic misconduct will include a grade of zero on the assignment, reduction in your final course grade with the possibility of a failing grade in the course depending on circumstances, among other possibilities.

Honesty requires that any ideas or materials taken from another source for either written or oral use must be fully acknowledged. Offering the work of someone else as one's own is plagiarism ([See section III, Student Misconduct, of the Code of Student Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct](#)).

Generative AI: Your use of anyone else's (or any AI system's) words, graphic images, calculations, or ideas should be properly cited. AI generators/programs such as ChatGPT, Grammarly, QuillBot, Spinbot, Dall-E, etc. should not be used for any work for this class without explicit permission of the instructor and appropriate attribution. AI text generators should not be used for:

- Creating or revising drafts
- Editing your work
- Reviewing a peer's work

The use of generative AI platforms will be considered plagiarism and/or cheating and will be reported to the Dean of Students

Note Selling and Online Course Materials

I have the exclusive right to distribute, modify, post, and reproduce course materials, including all written materials, study guides, lectures, assignments, exercises, and exams. Some of the course content may be downloadable for students who may only have intermittent access to the internet, but you should not

distribute, post, or alter a faculty member's intellectual property. The use of technologies for audio or video recording of lectures and other classroom activities is NOT allowed. Violations of this policy will be reported to the Dean of Students as academic misconduct.

Title IX and Sexual Misconduct

Title IX and our own Sexual Misconduct policy prohibit sexual misconduct. If you have experienced sexual misconduct, or know someone who has, the University can help. I encourage you to visit [Stop Sexual Violence website](#) to learn more. If you are seeking help and would like to speak to someone confidentially, you can make an appointment to receive [confidential resources](#). It is also important that you know that Title IX and University policy require me to share any information brought to my attention about potential sexual misconduct, with the campus Deputy Title IX Coordinator or IU's Title IX Coordinator. In that event, those individuals will work to ensure that appropriate measures are taken and resources are made available.

Bias-Based Incident Reporting

Bias-based incident reports can be made by students, faculty, and staff. Any act of discrimination or harassment based on race, ethnicity, religious affiliation, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, or disability can be reported through any of the options: 1) email biasincident@indiana.edu or incident@indiana.edu; 2) call the Dean of Students Office at (812) 855-8188 or 3) use the IU mobile App (m.iu.edu). Reports can be made anonymously.

Student Services

Accessibility

Every attempt will be made to accommodate qualified students with disabilities (e.g. mental health, learning, chronic health, physical, hearing, vision neurological, etc.) You must have established your eligibility for support services through the appropriate office that services students with disabilities. Please contact your campus office as soon as possible if accommodations are needed. Find your campus office serving students with disabilities.

Academic Support and Student Services

IU Online provides quick and easy access to tools, tips, and IU resources to help you succeed in your online courses, including:

Math and Writing Support: Direct access to IU-trained math mentors and writing consultants

Libraries and Research: Online access to IU library resources and research librarians

Technology: A full suite of software, collaboration tools, cloud storage, and training

For more information, visit: **[IU Online Academic Support](#)**

University Information Technology Services (UITS)

Students can also find answers to frequently asked technology questions in the **[IU Knowledge Base](#)**.

Get no-cost access to hundreds of software programs and applications (including Microsoft Office or Adobe Creative Cloud) through **[IUware](#)** and **[IUanyWare](#)**. All you need is your IU email address.

Use IUware to install software directly onto your hard drive. Use IUanyWare to stream 400+ apps on your desktop or through the mobile app with your IU login.

Student Mental Health Services

Students have several options for free mental health resources at IU. **[TimelyCare](#)** is a service that gives students 24/7 virtual access to mental health care professionals. There are also in-person services available at Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) which can be found **[here](#)**.

Other Resources

If you are experiencing food insecurity, IU has a food pantry called the Crimson Cupboard available to students. You can find information about the pantry **[here](#)**.

Other student support services, such as legal advice, emergency funds, financial aid resources, etc. can be found **[here](#)**. (Click on the dropdown menus to find other needed resources).

Course Schedule

This is the tentative course schedule which is *subject to change* when needed. Any days with “TBD” will be updated when possible (this does not mean there is not class – this will be updated ASAP).

Week	Day	Date	Topic	Reading	Assignment
Module 1. What is Criminology and Criminal Justice?					
Week 1	M	01/13	Class Introductions		Review Syllabus & Access book
	W	01/15	What is crime?	Chapter 2. Nature and Extent of Crime	
	F	01/17	What is crime?	Chapter 2. Nature and Extent of Crime	Exercise 1 due by 11:59PM
Week 2	M	01/20	NO CLASS - MLK Day		
	W	01/22	What is the CJ system? How did it develop?	Chapter 1. Crime and Criminal Justice	
	F	01/24	Why do people commit crimes?	Chapter 3. Understanding Crime and Victimization	Exercise 2 due by 11:59PM

Week 3	M	01/27	Why do people commit Crimes?	Chapter 3. Understanding Crime and Victimization	
	W	01/29	Why do people commit Crimes?	Chapter 3. Understanding Crime and Victimization	
	F	01/31	Where do crimes occur?	*Lecture material only (ecology of crime)	Exercise 3 due by 11:59PM
Week 4	M	02/03	What are the laws around crimes and the justice system?	Chapter 4. Criminal Law: Substance and Procedure	
	W	02/05	What are the laws around crimes and the justice system?	Chapter 4. Criminal Law: Substance and Procedure	
	F	02/07			Exam #1 due by 11:59PM (online - on Canvas)
	Sunday	02/09	-	-	Assignment #1 due by 11:59PM (02/09)
Module 2. Law Enforcement					
Week 5	M	02/10	What are the police?	Chapter 6. The Police: Organization, Role, and Function	
	W	02/12	What are the roles of the police?	Chapter 6. The Police: Organization, Role, and Function	

	F	02/14	Guest Lecture - State Police	Chapter 6. The Police: Organization, Role, and Function	Exercise 4 due by 11:59PM
Week 6	M	02/17	Policing Technology	Chapter 5. (ONLY pages 192 - 201)	
	W	02/19			
	F	02/21	Guest Lecture - Policing		Exercise 5 due by 11:59PM
Week 7	M	02/24	What are problems that police have?	Chapter 7. Issues in Policing	
	W	02/26		Chapter 7. Issues in Policing	
	F	02/28			Exercise 6 due by 11:59PM
Week 8	M	03/03	What are the laws surrounding the police?	Chapter 8. Police and the Rule of Law	
	W	03/05	What laws do police need to follow?	Chapter 8. Police and the Rule of Law	
	F	03/07			Exam #2 due by 11:59PM (online - on Canvas)
	Sunday	03/09	-	-	Assignment #2 due by 11:59PM (03/09)
Week 9	M	03/10	Guest Lecture - Cybercrime		
	W	03/12	TBD		
	F	03/14	TBD		Exercise 7 due by 11:59PM

Week 10	M	03/17	NO CLASS - Spring Break		
	W	03/19	NO CLASS - Spring Break		
	F	03/21	NO CLASS - Spring Break		
Module 3. Courts					
Week 11	M	03/24	How are our courts structured?	Chapter 9. Court Structure and Personnel	
	W	03/26	What are the roles of the court employees?	Chapter 9. Court Structure and Personnel	
	F	03/28	Guest Lecture - Small Claims Courts in Indy		Exercise 8 due by 11:59PM
	Sunday	03/30	-	-	Final Project Topic Selection due by 11:59PM (03/30)
Week 12	M	03/31	What happens in a trial?	Chapter 10. Pretrial and Trial Procedures	
	W	04/02	What are issues within a trial?	Chapter 10. Pretrial and Trial Procedures	
	F	04/04	TBD		Exercise 9 due by 11:59PM
	Sunday	04/06	-	-	Resubmissions (if required for student) due by 11:59PM

Week 13	M	04/07	How are sentences decided?	Chapter 11. Punishment and Sentencing	
	W	04/09	Are these working? What are alternatives?	Chapter 11. Punishment and Sentencing	
	F	04/11			Exam #3 due by 11:59PM (online - on Canvas)
	Sunday	04/13	-	-	Assignment #3 due by 11:59PM (04/13)
Module 4. Corrections					
Week 14	M	04/14	How did our prison system develop?	Chapter 13. History, Insitutions, and Populations	
	W	04/16	What does our prison system look like?	Chapter 13. History, Insitutions, and Populations	
	F	04/18	What are issues within our prison system?	Chapter 13. History, Insitutions, and Populations	Exercise 10 due by 11:59PM
Week 15	M	04/21	Does incarceration work?	Chapter 14. Prison Life: Living in and Leaving Prisons	
	W	04/23	Finish Corrections Unit		
	F	04/25			Exam #4 due by 11:59PM (online on Canvas)

Week 16	M	04/28	Work on Final Project		Final Project due by 11:59PM (04/28)
	W	04/30	Final Project Presentations		
	F	05/02	Final Project Presentations		
Finals Week	(05/05 - 05/09)	-	-	-	-

- See [here](#) for a full schedule of IUB dates
 - Spring Break: March 16th – March 23rd
 - Last Day of Classes: May 3rd
 - Final Exams: May 5th – May 9th